

Question 54 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse the consequences of designing a training program without conducting an adequate Training Needs Assessment.

Introduction

Consequence means what happens next, to work, to money, to people, and to HRD itself. Inadequate TNA means the designer did not properly study organisation goals, tasks, persons, and non-training causes. Design then aims at a fog. Analyse a chain of effects, not a single sentence 'it will fail'.

Detailed points

- 1. Wrong content — the original problem continues.** Topics miss the real KSA gaps. Errors, delays or rude service continue. Staff and customers see no benefit. Operational consequence is 'we trained and nothing changed'.
- 2. Wrong audience.** Skilled staff are bored (they may even give poor reaction); needy staff are absent. Development equity fails. The people who needed help remain unhelped.
- 3. Wrong method.** A lecture is used where coaching was needed, or a two-day off-site where a one-week OJT would have worked. Learning and transfer fail even if the topic name was roughly right.
- 4. Training as a false solution — the dangerous consequence.** System problems (machine, incentive, staffing) remain. Management thinks 'we already trained them' and stops looking. The next time errors occur, workers are blamed personally. This consequence is moral as well as operational.
- 5. Demotivation and cynicism about HRD.** Employees lose faith. Future programmes suffer 'attendance of the body but not of the mind'. Climate worsens. Later even a good TNA-based course is harder to run.
- 6. Wasted budget and lost production time.** Direct vendor cost plus opportunity cost of people away from work. In a tight organisation this is serious. Mention both costs in the exam.
- 7. Evaluation becomes theatre.** No true objectives or baseline, so anyone can claim success or failure. The training cycle cannot learn. HRD cannot improve.
- 8. Strategic drift over time.** The calendar becomes a ritual disconnected from goals. Capability lag appears in a crisis — quality failure, digital lag. Consequence is long-term organisational weakness, not only one bad course.

Conclusion. *Without adequate TNA, design produces wrong content, people and methods; hides real causes; wastes money; creates cynicism; and blocks honest evaluation and strategy. Adequate TNA is professional risk control, not extra paperwork. Analyse this chain in the answer book.*